

Dhāraṇī of the Array of Stalks Sūtra

Gaṇḍavyūhadhāraṇī · Toh 585 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྡེ་པ་བློ་པ་འགྲུག་

Toh 585 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text associated with the Gaṇḍavyūha, known in Sanskrit as the Gaṇḍavyūhadhāraṇī and in Tibetan in connection with the sūtra called Sdong po bkod pa, meaning the Array of Stalks. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts preserving sacred syllables and mantra formulas held to carry concentrated spiritual power. This particular text consists of a brief mantra invocation addressed to the buddhas whose teaching is unobstructed, and it carries the remarkable claim that reciting or holding this dhāraṇī is equivalent to having perfectly read the entirety of the vast and celebrated Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra, one of the great Mahāyāna scriptures describing the spiritual journey of the youth Sudhana. Its inclusion in the Kangyur reflects the tradition of condensing the merit of extensive canonical works into a single potent dhāraṇī formula.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namas samantabuddhānāṃ. Apratihataśāsanānāṃ. Oṃ kiṇi kiṇi tathāgatotbhava śānte varade. Uttama uttama tathāgata. Utbhava hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

By holding this dhāraṇī, one has perfectly read the entire noble sūtra known as the Array of Stalks (Skt. Gaṇḍavyūha).

Translator's Notes

- The passage closes with a standard substitution formula found at the end of dhāraṇīs appended to large sūtras: reciting the dhāraṇī is declared equivalent in merit to reading the entire Gaṇḍavyūhasūtra (Tib. གཏུགས་པ་སྡེ་པ་བློ་པ་འགྲུག་), the final chapter of the Avataṃsakasūtra. The Sanskrit syllables of the dhāraṇī are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and are standard for this formula; minor orthographic variation from canonical Sanskrit is normal in Tibetan transmission.

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.